figured prominently at this Modi–Xi summit. As a result of their deliberations, they agreed to work together in the neighbour-hood, the beginning of which was made from Afghanistan. However, it would be naïve to expect that China would relent on its South Asia push just to make India feel comfortable in its immediate neighbourhood.

Despite all these attempts, India does not see any real letup in the intensity of Chinese assertion in the region and the force of its BRI push. India has not yet revised its strong resistance to the Chinese BRI, and the prospects are that Sino–Indian competition will continue unabated in India's immediate neighbour-hood. Cooperation and competition are the combined modes of engagement between India and China since the British period, and there is no way it is going to be otherwise. Prime Minister Modi's statement at the Shangri-La Dialogue in Singapore on June 2018 may be recalled here, when he said, "no other relationship of India has as many layers as our relationship with China."[33] It is time that India did serious homework to craft a China policy that can effectively address these layers when they start unfolding one after another to India's discomfort. For resisting China's push into South Asia, India has not only to enhance its capabilities but also redefine its priorities such that at least the domestic political agenda does not vitiate regional strategic stakes.

Notes

1 Central Tibetan Administration (2014), "Sikyong Attends Swearing-in Ceremony of Prime Minister Narendra Modi," 27 May. Accessed 7 April 2020. https://tibet.net/sikyong-attends-swearing-in-ceremony-of-prime-minister-narendra-modi/; Bagchi, Indrani (2014), "Tibetan Leader at Modi's Swearing in Irks China," *The Times of India*, 5 June. Accessed 7 April 2020. https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/Tibetan-leader-at-Modis-swearing-in-irks-China/articleshow/36080500.cms.